

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 10 5

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 8 4 2

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 8

♦ K 9 7 3

♣ K Q J 10



♠ K 10 2

♥ 6 4 3

♦ Q J 10 6

♣ A 6 5

♠ A 9 5

♥ A K J 9 7 2

♦ 8

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
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Pass	2♣	Pass	1♥
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Pass	4♥		
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All Pass

4♥ by South

he can only make one ♠ trick when you play correctly.

[showcards W:S3 N:S4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠3, dummy played the ♠4

Play the ♠10.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you that he has an honor in the suit. There are only two ♠ honors you can't see, and you know he wouldn't underlead an Ace at a suit contract. So partner holds the ♠Q.

You can see clearly what would happen if you played Third-hand-high and put on your ♠K. Declarer would win his ♠A and could then set up a second ♠ trick by leading toward dummy's ♠J.

By playing the ♠10 you force declarer to win with the ♠A if he wants the trick. But however he plays

For your side, 2 ♠ tricks and the two minor Aces spell defeat.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ 8 7 5

♣ 10 6 4

♠ K 5 3

♥ A J 8

♦ Q 9 6

♣ Q J 5 2



♠ 6 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ K J 10 3

♣ A K 8 3

♠ A J 9 2

♥ 10 7 5 3

♦ A 4 2

♣ 9 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

you to pick up dummy's ♠K and four ♠ winners. Along with the ♦A you will defeat the contract.

[showcards W:S7 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠7, dummy played the ♠3

Play the ♠2.

Partner has led a small card, so it is surely fourth-down. That means you should automatically apply the Rule of Eleven.

11 minus 7 equals 4, so there are just 4 cards higher than the 7 between dummy, you, and declarer. **AND YOU CAN SEE ALL FOUR OF THEM.**

Declarer has no card that can beat the ♠7, and the only way you can beat this contract is to let partner's ♠7 hold the trick. He will continue the suit, allowing ♦A you will defeat the contract.

If you play ANY card except your ♠2 on the first trick you will not be able to win four tricks in the suit because you cannot get West back into the lead. And declarer will make the contract easily.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3
 ♥ 8 2
 ♦ 10 9 5 4 2
 ♣ K 8 6 3

♠ K 10 7 5

♥ 6

♦ K 8 3

♣ Q J 9 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6 4

♥ K 10 9 7 4 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ A 10

♠ A Q J 8 2

♥ A Q J 5

♦ J 6

♣ 7 4

West	North	East	South
		1♥	1♠
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			

[showcards W:H8 N:H6]

The bidding has been as shown. North's 2♥ bid shows good ♠ support with at least 10 points.

Partner led the ♥8, dummy played the ♥6

Play a small ♥.

Partner's ♥8 lead is a high spot card, either top-of-nothing, or a singleton or doubleton. He definitely does not have an honor, which means that South holds ♥ A Q J.

In other words, your ♥K is dead in the water. BUT, if you play it to this trick you hand South three ♥ tricks, while if you play a low ♥ he can only get 2 winners in the suit.

The extra winner would permit South to discard 2 of dummy's ♦ losers, and this would give South the contract.